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SIXTEEN YEARS OF HUNTING, ZERO INHERITED BOOKS

Sixteen years, seven seats, zero inherited books. Every patch I have been given started empty and every number I have hit was built on pipeline I created. The clearest examples:

- Cloudflare. Thirty five named targets, cold outbound only, no inbound support whatsoever, \$4M of funnel created and 115 percent delivered on a \$1M quota.
- Couchbase. 135 percent of quota with every dollar coming from net-new logos, achieved through a pre-IPO and IPO year with no territory plan waiting for me.
- Analyst1. Early commercial hire, thirteen states, empty funnel. Five cold enterprise logos closed in the first year.
- Red Hat. Three straight years above plan, peaking at 160 percent against \$7M, with a \$5M annual Centene agreement won against an incumbent.

INDUSTRIAL AND MANUFACTURING ACCOUNTS CLOSED

- Emerson, Red Hat. Industrial automation manufacturer, won as a new logo.
- Platform automation sold into manufacturing environments across my Red Hat tenure. Buyers were IT and platform engineering, and the value argument was engineering hours recovered from repetitive work.
- Exxon, Alfresco. Major industrial account won with implementation services attached.
- SLB, Analyst1. Oilfield services and industrial equipment, closed cold in Houston this year.
- Post Holdings and Anheuser-Busch, Couchbase. Food and beverage manufacturing, both opened cold.
- Graybar, Cloudflare. Industrial and electrical distribution.
- Ameren, Xcel Energy, OG&E and FirstEnergy. Utilities and power generation across multiple employers.
- American Airlines and Enterprise Holdings. Transportation and fleet operations.

Carrier and telecommunications accounts worked over the course of my career include AT&T, Lumen Technologies and CenturyLink, Sprint and WorldCom.

HOW I BREAK INTO A COLD ACCOUNT

Target. I rank a named list on observable signal ahead of raw revenue. Job postings naming specific equipment or systems, capital expenditure commentary on earnings calls, plant expansions, safety or regulatory filings, leadership changes in operations, and whatever partners are already hearing on site.

Reach. Outbound opens with a hypothesis about that specific site and that specific problem. Generic value propositions get deleted, and I would rather send twelve researched messages than four hundred templated ones.

Discover. Deep technical discovery means walking the current process step by step, including who touches it, what it costs when it fails, and how anyone finds out. The metric we agree on during discovery is the metric the business case is built on later.

Champion. I map the account for the person whose year gets better if this works, then arm them for the conversations happening when I am out of the room. Multi-threading across four or more stakeholders is standard practice for me, and single-threaded deals get flagged as risk in my own forecast.

Quantify. The case gets written with the finance owner using their own loaded cost figures. At Red Hat this discipline carried a \$5M annual agreement through a CFO organization that scrutinized every line.

Close. Mutual close plan in HubSpot from the first qualified call, with security review, procurement and legal running as parallel tracks so none of them surprises me in the final week.

THE PROCUREMENT ADVANTAGE

Before I ever carried a quota I worked in corporate procurement. I know how a vendor package gets scored, what sourcing does with a proposal once it lands and which clauses draw redlines. Your posting names procurement and legal as hurdles to get past. For me that stage is usually where I gain ground, because the business case arrives in the format finance already uses and pricing structure is on the table before anyone has to ask for it.

ATTAINMENT RECORD

- Red Hat: three consecutive years above target, peaking at 160 percent against \$7M.
- Alfresco: 146 percent of a \$4M team target, \$1.5M carried personally.
- Couchbase: 135 percent of quota, all net-new, pipeline up 45 percent to roughly \$4M.
- Gigamon: 125 percent of a \$750K regional number.
- Cloudflare: quota of \$1M closed at 115 percent, with partner-sourced revenue up 25 percent.
- President's Club at three employers.

TOOLS AND METHOD

HubSpot is my working CRM at Analyst1 today, and Salesforce with Clari came before it at Gigamon and Cloudflare. MEDDPICC is how I qualify, and I carry Command of the Message training into how I frame value. Forecast accuracy matters to me as a personal standard, so I bring risk to my manager before my manager finds it.

WHERE I WOULD BE LEARNING

My buyer set has been infrastructure, security, platform engineering and finance leadership. Manufacturing itself is familiar, and I sold platform automation into manufacturing environments at Red Hat, though my counterparts there were IT and platform engineering. A maintenance and reliability organization on the plant floor is the buyer I have never carried a bag into, and I would rather name that than paper over it. The surrounding deal is familiar: IT and OT integration review, security assessment, a quantified payback period and a procurement cycle. I have also spent years selling software against freely available alternatives, which forced me to get good at proving value that a buyer could otherwise talk themselves out of paying for.

COVERAGE AND TRAVEL

Based in the Central US with Chicago and Austin both inside a routine travel pattern, and Texas already inside the thirteen-state region I cover today. Twenty five percent travel sits below what I do now. I have worked remotely for distributed organizations at Red Hat, Couchbase, Cloudflare, Gigamon and Analyst1.

EDUCATION

University of Arkansas, Walton College. MBA and BSBA.